Zuri and the Footprints After Rain

A Copper Tree story and colouring adventure



A story to share. A world to make your own.

Created by Emotive Impact

You are part of the adventure.

Meet six friends who live in Copper Tree. They ask questions, make things, make mistakes and help each other. There is room for you too.

Amara
An artist with wonderfully big ideas.

Kofi
An inventor who loves figuring things out.

Zuri
An explorer with a question for everything.

Eli
A playful friend who loves a good game.

Nia
A gardener who notices the little things.

Tayo
A dreamer who keeps looking up.

Read together or on your own. After every two story pages, there is a picture to colour. Use the drawing spaces for your own ideas. You can tell someone your answer instead of writing it.

Grown-ups: print at actual size on A4 paper. Single-sided printing is helpful for colouring. Try pencils or crayons first. Place scrap paper underneath if using felt-tip pens.

Something in the Mud

Rain had washed Copper Tree clean. Outside the Lookout, the friends' garden clubhouse, Zuri spotted muddy marks beside an overturned flowerpot.

“Footprints!” she whispered.

Tayo peered over her shoulder. “Something has landed.”

“Something with paws,” said Zuri.

Under the bench, Crumpet the neighbourhood cat opened one eye.

Zuri pointed. “And there is our suspect.”

Your turn

Draw a garden after rain. Include three things you might notice on a rainy morning.

The First Guess

Crumpet stretched, yawned and sat on Amara's sketchbook.
“He looks guilty,” said Eli.
“He looks comfortable,” said Nia.
Zuri drew a cat beside the footprints. Then she added a large tick.
Kofi adjusted his glasses. “Did anyone see him make them?”
Zuri's pencil stopped.
“Well, no. But he is right here.”
“So are we,” said Nia.

Your turn

Draw your first guess about the visitor. Leave room beside it for another idea.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 1



Following Carefully

Mrs Bennett was sweeping the garden path.
“May we follow the marks?” Zuri asked.
“Along the paths, with me,” she said. “Leave the beds to the plants.”
The prints crossed a patch of mud and stopped at the gravel.
“The creature vanished!” said Tayo.
“Or walked somewhere that leaves fewer marks,” said Kofi.
They all looked at the gravel.

Your turn

Draw garden beds with a path between them. Keep your route around the plants.

A Gap in the Hedge

Beyond the gravel, Nia noticed another muddy patch beside a gap beneath the hedge.
“There are more over here.”
Zuri leaned forward, then stopped at the path's edge.
“Perhaps Crumpet went through.”
“Perhaps,” Mrs Bennett agreed. “We can look from here.”
Amara sketched the gap.
Eli held her pencil case. For once, he managed to stand completely still.

Your turn

Draw a leafy hedge. Invent a tiny creature that could shelter underneath it.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 2



A Very Unhelpful Cat

They returned to find Crumpet asleep on Zuri's notebook.
“He has eaten the evidence,” Tayo announced.
“He is sitting on it,” said Amara.
Zuri gently slid the notebook free. Her large tick stared back at her.
Below it, she wrote a question mark.
“I still think it might be Crumpet,” she said. “But thinking isn't the same as seeing.”

Your turn

Draw something funny Crumpet might choose as a bed. Give Zuri a new question to investigate.

The Garden Camera

“There might be a way to look back,” said Mrs Bennett.
She showed them the little wildlife camera facing the hedge.
She used it to see which animals visited after dark.
“Can it see yesterday?” asked Tayo.
“If it recorded something.”
Mrs Bennett fetched her tablet. The six friends gathered beside her.
Zuri held her notebook open at a fresh page.

Your turn

Design a cover for the crew’s garden wildlife notebook. Draw an animal you would like to learn about.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 3



Wait for the Visitor

On the screen, the garden was grey and quiet.
A leaf fluttered. Rain splashed. Nothing happened.
“Excellent film about a leaf,” Eli whispered.
Then a pointed nose appeared beneath the hedge.
Two ears followed. A narrow body slipped through, then a long, bushy tail.
“A fox!” Zuri breathed.
Everybody leaned closer. Mrs Bennett paused the recording so everyone could see.

Your turn

Draw the visitor appearing from behind a leaf. What would you notice first?

Across the Mud

Mrs Bennett played the next part. The fox stepped across the muddy patch, passed over the gravel and walked beside the flowerpot.
Its flank brushed the pot. Over it went.
“There!” cried Zuri. “We can see it happening!”
The fox trotted away.
Crumpet padded into the garden much later. He walked straight to the bench and curled up.

Your turn

Draw the fox’s journey through the garden. What happens at the end?

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 4



A Better Answer

Zuri looked at her cat drawing.
“I was wrong about Crumpet.”
“And you found out,” said Kofi.
Zuri rubbed out the tick and drew a fox beside the cat.
Amara passed her an orange pencil. “A new clue deserves a new picture.”
Underneath, Zuri wrote, “The camera showed a fox making the trail.”
That felt better than being certain.

Your turn

Draw Zuri’s new answer beside a picture of her first guess. Tell someone what helped her change her mind.

Room for Visitors

Mrs Bennett stood the empty pot upright and moved it away from the narrow path.
“We can give our visitors room,” said Nia.
They left the hedge gap clear and made a wildlife page for the Lookout.
“Shall we invite the fox inside?” asked Tayo.
“Outside is its place,” said Mrs Bennett.
“Crumpet hasn't read that rule,” said Eli.

Your turn

Design a wildlife page with room for drawings of garden visitors. Add a quiet place to watch from.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 5



The Next Morning

The next morning, Zuri arrived with her notebook. Fresh marks dotted the damp path.
“Another fox?” asked Eli.
“Maybe,” said Zuri, smiling. “Let's see what we can find out.”
Mrs Bennett raised one muddy boot.
“Would this help?”
The friends burst out laughing.
Zuri drew a boot on her page. Her notebook had room for all sorts of answers.

Your turn

Invent a funny boot-sole pattern. Draw the trail it could leave across your page.

The Question Shelf

Inside the Lookout, the friends added their wildlife notebook to the discovery shelf.
Zuri wrote a message on the first page. “Look closely. Ask questions. Leave room for surprises.”
Crumpet jumped onto the empty chair beside her.
“I know what you are doing,” she told him.
He curled up and closed his eyes.
This time, Zuri had seen it for herself.

Your turn

Draw yourself visiting the Lookout. What question would you add to the wildlife notebook?

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 6



A place for you

Draw yourself with the Copper Tree friends. Where would you meet? What would you bring to share?

What happens next?

Invent another adventure. Draw the first thing the friends discover. Give your adventure a name, or tell someone your story.